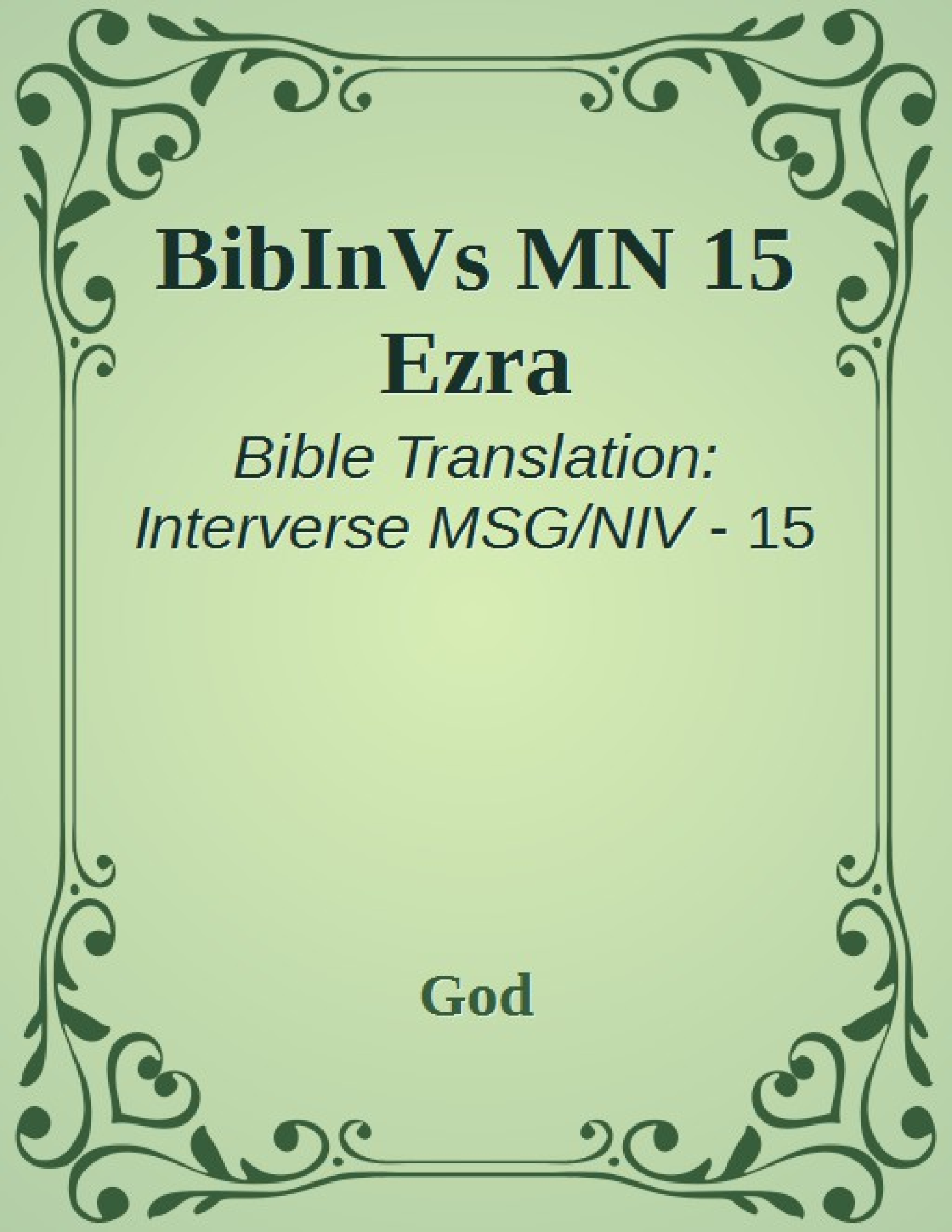


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 15

Ezra

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 15*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Ezra

Ezra 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the first year of Cyrus king of Persia--this fulfilled the Message of GOD preached by Jeremiah--GOD prodded Cyrus king of Persia to make an official announcement throughout his kingdom. He wrote it out as follows:
 - 1 In the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, in order to fulfill the word of the LORD spoken by Jeremiah, the LORD moved the heart of Cyrus king of Persia to make a proclamation throughout his realm and to put it in writing:
 - 2 From Cyrus king of Persia, a Proclamation: GOD, the God of the heavens, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth. He has also assigned me to build him a Temple of worship in Jerusalem, Judah.
 - 2 This is what Cyrus king of Persia says: 'The LORD, the God of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth and he has appointed me to build a temple for him at Jerusalem in Judah.
 - 3 Who among you belongs to his people? God be with you! Go to Jerusalem which is in Judah and build The Temple of GOD, the God of Israel, Jerusalem's God.
 - 3 Anyone of his people among you--may his God be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem in Judah and build the temple of the LORD, the God of Israel, the God who is in Jerusalem.
 - 4 Those who stay behind, wherever they happen to live, will support them with silver, gold, tools, and pack animals, along with Freewill-Offerings for The Temple of God in Jerusalem.
 - 4 And the people of any place where survivors may now be living are to provide him with silver and gold, with goods and livestock, and with freewill offerings for the temple of God in Jerusalem.' "

- 5 The heads of the families of Judah and Benjamin, along with the priests and Levites--everyone, in fact, God prodded--set out to build The Temple of GOD in Jerusalem.
- 5 Then the family heads of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests and Levites--everyone whose heart God had moved--prepared to go up and build the house of the LORD in Jerusalem.
- 6 Their neighbors rallied behind them enthusiastically with silver, gold, tools, pack animals, expensive gifts, and, over and above these, Freewill-Offerings.
- 6 All their neighbors assisted them with articles of silver and gold, with goods and livestock, and with valuable gifts, in addition to all the freewill offerings.
- 7 Also, King Cyrus turned over to them all the vessels and utensils from The Temple of GOD that Nebuchadnezzar had hauled from Jerusalem and put in the temple of his gods.
- 7 Moreover, King Cyrus brought out the articles belonging to the temple of the LORD, which Nebuchadnezzar had carried away from Jerusalem and had placed in the temple of his god.
- 8 Cyrus king of Persia put Mithredath the treasurer in charge of the transfer; he provided a full inventory for Sheshbazzar the prince of Judah, including the following:
- 8 Cyrus king of Persia had them brought by Mithredath the treasurer, who counted them out to Sheshbazzar the prince of Judah.
- 9 30 gold dishes, 1,000 silver dishes
- 9 This was the inventory: gold dishes 30 silver dishes 1,000 silver pans 29
- 10 29 silver pans, 30 gold bowls, 410 duplicate silver bowls, 1,000 miscellaneous items.
- 10 gold bowls 30 matching silver bowls 410 other articles 1,000
- 11 All told, there were 5,400 gold and silver articles that Sheshbazzar took with him when he brought the exiles back from Babylon to Jerusalem.
- 11 In all, there were 5,400 articles of gold and of silver. Sheshbazzar brought all these along when the exiles came up from Babylon to Jerusalem.

Ezra 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the people from the province who now returned from the captivity, exiles whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried off captive. They returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his hometown.
- 1 Now these are the people of the province who came up from the captivity of the exiles, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had taken captive to Babylon (they returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his own town,
- 2 They came in company with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, and Baanah. The numbers of the returning Israelites by families of origin were as follows:
- 2 in company with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum and Baanah): The list of the men of the people of Israel:
- 3 Parosh, 2,172
- 3 the descendants of Parosh 2,172
- 4 Shephatiah, 372
- 4 of Shephatiah 372
- 5 Arah, 775
- 5 of Arah 775
- 6 Pahath-Moab (sons of Jeshua and Joab), 2,812
- 6 of Pahath-Moab (through the line of Jeshua and Joab) 2,812
- 7 Elam, 1,254
- 7 of Elam 1,254
- 8 Zattu, 945
- 8 of Zattu 945
- 9 Zaccai, 760
- 9 of Zaccai 760
- 10 Bani, 642
- 10 of Bani 642
- 11 Bebai, 623
- 11 of Bebai 623
- 12 Azgad, 1,222
- 12 of Azgad 1,222
- 13 Adonikam, 666
- 13 of Adonikam 666

14 Bigvai, 2,056
14 of Bigvai 2,056
15 Adin, 454
15 of Adin 454
16 Ater (sons of Hezekiah), 98
16 of Ater (through Hezekiah) 98
17 Bezai, 323
17 of Bezai 323
18 Jorah, 112
18 of Jorah 112
19 Hashum, 223
19 of Hashum 223
20 Gibbar, 95.
20 of Gibbar 95
21 Israelites identified by place of origin were as follows: Bethlehem, 123
21 the men of Bethlehem 123
22 Netophah, 56
22 of Netophah 56
23 Anathoth, 128
23 of Anathoth 128
24 Azmaveth, 42
24 of Azmaveth 42
25 Kiriath Jearim, Kephirah, and Beeroth, 743
25 of Kiriath Jearim, Kephirah and Beeroth 743
26 Ramah and Geba, 621
26 of Ramah and Geba 621
27 Micmash, 122
27 of Micmash 122
28 Bethel and Ai, 223
28 of Bethel and Ai 223
29 Nebo, 52
29 of Nebo 52
30 Magbish, 156
30 of Magbish 156
31 Elam (the other one), 1,254
31 of the other Elam 1,254

- 32 Harim, 320
- 32 of Harim 320
- 33 Lod, Hadid, and Ono, 725
- 33 of Lod, Hadid and Ono 725
- 34 Jericho, 345
- 34 of Jericho 345
- 35 Senaah, 3,630.
- 35 of Senaah 3,630
- 36 Priestly families: Jedaiah (sons of Jeshua), 973
- 36 The priests: the descendants of Jedaiah (through the family of Jeshua) 973
- 37 Immer, 1,052
- 37 of Immer 1,052
- 38 Pashhur, 1,247
- 38 of Pashhur 1,247
- 39 Harim, 1,017.
- 39 of Harim 1,017
- 40 Levitical families: Jeshua and Kadmiel (sons of Hodaviah), 74.
- 40 The Levites: the descendants of Jeshua and Kadmiel (through the line of Hodaviah) 74
- 41 Singers: Asaph's family line, 128.
- 41 The singers: the descendants of Asaph 128
- 42 Security guard families: Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Akkub, Hatita, and Shobai, 139.
- 42 The gatekeepers of the temple: the descendants of Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Akkub, Hatita and Shobai 139
- 43 Families of temple support staff: Ziha, Hasupha, Tabbaoth,
- 43 The temple servants: the descendants of Ziha, Hasupha, Tabbaoth,
- 44 Keros, Siaha, Padon,
- 44 Keros, Siaha, Padon,
- 45 Lebanah, Hagabah, Akkub,
- 45 Lebanah, Hagabah, Akkub,
- 46 Hagab, Shalmal, Hanan,
- 46 Hagab, Shalmal, Hanan,
- 47 Giddel, Gahar, Reaiah,
- 47 Giddel, Gahar, Reaiah,

48 Rezin, Nekoda, Gazzam,
48 Rezin, Nekoda, Gazzam,
49 Uzza, Paseah, Besai,
49 Uzza, Paseah, Besai,
50 Asnah, Meunim, Nephussim,
50 Asnah, Meunim, Nephussim,
51 Bakbuk, Hakupha, Harhur,
51 Bakbuk, Hakupha, Harhur,
52 Bazluth, Mehida, Harsha,
52 Bazluth, Mehida, Harsha,
53 Barkos, Sisera, Temah,
53 Barkos, Sisera, Temah,
54 Neziah, and Hatipha.
54 Neziah and Hatipha
55 Families of Solomon's servants: Sotai, Hassophereth, Peruda,
55 The descendants of the servants of Solomon: the descendants of Sotai,
Hassophereth, Peruda,
56 Jaala, Darkon, Giddel,
56 Jaala, Darkon, Giddel,
57 Shephatiah, Hattil, Pokereth-Hazzebaim, and Ami.
57 Shephatiah, Hattil, Pokereth-Hazzebaim and Ami
58 Temple support staff and Solomon's servants added up to 392.
58 The temple servants and the descendants of the servants of Solomon
392
59 These are those who came from Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Kerub, Addon,
and Immer. They weren't able to prove their ancestry, whether they were
true Israelites or not:
59 The following came up from the towns of Tel Melah, Tel Harsha,
Kerub, Addon and Immer, but they could not show that their families
were descended from Israel:
60 Delaiah, Tobiah, and Nekoda, 652 in all.
60 The descendants of Delaiah, Tobiah and Nekoda 652
61 Likewise with these priestly families: Hobaiah, Hakkoz, and Barzillai,
who had married a daughter of Barzillai the Gileadite and took that
name.

61 And from among the priests: The descendants of Hobaiah, Hakkoz and Barzillai (a man who had married a daughter of Barzillai the Gileadite and was called by that name).

62 They had thoroughly searched for their family records but couldn't find them. And so they were barred from priestly work as ritually unclean.

62 These searched for their family records, but they could not find them and so were excluded from the priesthood as unclean.

63 The governor ruled that they could not eat from the holy food until a priest could determine their status with the Urim and Thummim.

63 The governor ordered them not to eat any of the most sacred food until there was a priest ministering with the Urim and Thummim.

64 The total count for the congregation was 42,360.

64 The whole company numbered 42,360,

65 That did not include the male and female slaves, which numbered 7,337. There were also 200 male and female singers,

65 besides their 7,337 menservants and maidservants; and they also had 200 men and women singers.

66 and they had 736 horses, 245 mules,

66 They had 736 horses, 245 mules,

67 435 camels, and 6,720 donkeys.

67 435 camels and 6,720 donkeys.

68 Some of the heads of families, on arriving at The Temple of GOD in Jerusalem, made Freewill-Offerings toward the rebuilding of The Temple of God on its site.

68 When they arrived at the house of the LORD in Jerusalem, some of the heads of the families gave freewill offerings toward the rebuilding of the house of God on its site.

69 They gave to the building fund as they were able, about 1,100 pounds of gold, about three tons of silver, and 100 priestly robes.

69 According to their ability they gave to the treasury for this work 61,000 drachmas of gold, 5,000 minas of silver and 100 priestly garments.

70 The priests, Levites, and some of the people lived in Jerusalem. The singers, security guards, and temple support staff found places in their hometowns. All the Israelites found a place to live.

70 The priests, the Levites, the singers, the gatekeepers and the temple servants settled in their own towns, along with some of the other people,

and the rest of the Israelites settled in their towns.

Ezra 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 When the seventh month came and the Israelites had settled into their towns, the people assembled together in Jerusalem.
- 1 When the seventh month came and the Israelites had settled in their towns, the people assembled as one man in Jerusalem.
- 2 Jeshua son of Jozadak and his brother priests, along with Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel, and his relatives, went to work and built the Altar of the God of Israel to offer Whole-Burnt-Offerings on it as written in The Revelation of Moses the man of God.
- 2 Then Jeshua son of Jozadak and his fellow priests and Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and his associates began to build the altar of the God of Israel to sacrifice burnt offerings on it, in accordance with what is written in the Law of Moses the man of God.
- 3 Even though they were afraid of what their non-Israelite neighbors might do, they went ahead anyway and set up the Altar on its foundations and offered Whole-Burnt-Offerings on it morning and evening.
- 3 Despite their fear of the peoples around them, they built the altar on its foundation and sacrificed burnt offerings on it to the LORD, both the morning and evening sacrifices.
- 4 They also celebrated the Festival of Booths as prescribed and the daily Whole-Burnt-Offerings set for each day.
- 4 Then in accordance with what is written, they celebrated the Feast of Tabernacles with the required number of burnt offerings prescribed for each day.
- 5 And they presented the regular Whole-Burnt-Offerings for Sabbaths, New Moons, and GOD's Holy Festivals, as well as Freewill-Offerings for GOD.
- 5 After that, they presented the regular burnt offerings, the New Moon sacrifices and the sacrifices for all the appointed sacred feasts of the LORD, as well as those brought as freewill offerings to the LORD.

- 6 They began offering Whole-Burnt-Offerings to GOD from the very first day of the seventh month, even though The Temple of GOD's foundation had not yet been laid.
- 6 On the first day of the seventh month they began to offer burnt offerings to the LORD, though the foundation of the LORD's temple had not yet been laid.
- 7 They gave money to hire masons and carpenters. They gave food, drink, and oil to the Sidonians and Tyrians in exchange for the cedar lumber they had brought by sea from Lebanon to Joppa, a shipment authorized by Cyrus the king of Persia.
- 7 Then they gave money to the masons and carpenters, and gave food and drink and oil to the people of Sidon and Tyre, so that they would bring cedar logs by sea from Lebanon to Joppa, as authorized by Cyrus king of Persia.
- 8 In the second month of the second year after their arrival at The Temple of God in Jerusalem, Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua son of Jozadak, in company with their brother priests and Levites and everyone else who had come back to Jerusalem from captivity, got started. They appointed the Levites twenty years of age and older to direct the rebuilding of The Temple of GOD.
- 8 In the second month of the second year after their arrival at the house of God in Jerusalem, Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, Jeshua son of Jozadak and the rest of their brothers (the priests and the Levites and all who had returned from the captivity to Jerusalem) began the work, appointing Levites twenty years of age and older to supervise the building of the house of the LORD.
- 9 Jeshua and his family joined Kadmiel, Binnui, and Hodaviah, along with the extended family of Henadad--all Levites--to direct the work crew on The Temple of God.
- 9 Jeshua and his sons and brothers and Kadmiel and his sons (descendants of Hodaviah) and the sons of Henadad and their sons and brothers--all Levites--joined together in supervising those working on the house of God.
- 10 When the workers laid the foundation of The Temple of GOD, the priests in their robes stood up with trumpets, and the Levites, sons of

Asaph, with cymbals, to praise GOD in the tradition of David king of Israel.

- 10 When the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the LORD, the priests in their vestments and with trumpets, and the Levites (the sons of Asaph) with cymbals, took their places to praise the LORD, as prescribed by David king of Israel.
- 11 They sang antiphonally praise and thanksgiving to GOD: Yes! GOD is good! Oh yes--he'll never quit loving Israel! All the people boomed out hurrahs, praising GOD as the foundation of The Temple of GOD was laid.
- 11 With praise and thanksgiving they sang to the LORD: "He is good; his love to Israel endures forever." And all the people gave a great shout of praise to the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.
- 12 As many were noisily shouting with joy, many of the older priests, Levites, and family heads who had seen the first Temple, when they saw the foundations of this Temple laid, wept loudly for joy.
- 12 But many of the older priests and Levites and family heads, who had seen the former temple, wept aloud when they saw the foundation of this temple being laid, while many others shouted for joy.
- 13 People couldn't distinguish the shouting from the weeping. The sound of their voices reverberated for miles around.
- 13 No one could distinguish the sound of the shouts of joy from the sound of weeping, because the people made so much noise. And the sound was heard far away.

Ezra 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Old enemies of Judah and Benjamin heard that the exiles were building The Temple of the GOD of Israel.
- 1 When the enemies of Judah and Benjamin heard that the exiles were building a temple for the LORD, the God of Israel,
- 2 They came to Zerubbabel and the family heads and said, "We'll help you build. We worship your God the same as you. We've been offering

- sacrifices to him since Esarhaddon king of Assyria brought us here."
- 2 they came to Zerubbabel and to the heads of the families and said, "Let us help you build because, like you, we seek your God and have been sacrificing to him since the time of Esarhaddon king of Assyria, who brought us here."
- 3 Zerubbabel, Jeshua, and the rest of the family heads of Israel said to them, "Nothing doing. Building The Temple of our God is not the same thing to you as to us. We alone will build for the GOD of Israel. We're the ones King Cyrus of Persia commanded to do it."
- 3 But Zerubbabel, Jeshua and the rest of the heads of the families of Israel answered, "You have no part with us in building a temple to our God. We alone will build it for the LORD, the God of Israel, as King Cyrus, the king of Persia, commanded us."
- 4 So these people started beating down the morale of the people of Judah, harassing them as they built.
- 4 Then the peoples around them set out to discourage the people of Judah and make them afraid to go on building.
- 5 They even hired propagandists to sap their resolve. They kept this up for about fifteen years, throughout the lifetime of Cyrus king of Persia and on into the reign of Darius king of Persia.
- 5 They hired counselors to work against them and frustrate their plans during the entire reign of Cyrus king of Persia and down to the reign of Darius king of Persia.
- 6 In fact, in the reign of Xerxes, at the beginning of his reign, they wrote an accusation against those living in Judah and Jerusalem.
- 6 At the beginning of the reign of Xerxes, they lodged an accusation against the people of Judah and Jerusalem.
- 7 Again later, in the time of Artaxerxes, Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and their associates wrote regarding the Jerusalem business to Artaxerxes king of Persia. The letter was written in Aramaic and translated. (What follows is written in Aramaic.)
- 7 And in the days of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel and the rest of his associates wrote a letter to Artaxerxes. The letter was written in Aramaic script and in the Aramaic language.
- 8 Rehum the commanding officer and Shimshai the secretary wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king as follows:

- 8 Rehum the commanding officer and Shimshai the secretary wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king as follows:
- 9 From: Rehum the commanding officer and Shimshai the secretary, backed by the rest of their associates, the judges and officials over the people from Tripolis, Persia, Erech, and Babylon, Elamites of Susa,
- 9 Rehum the commanding officer and Shimshai the secretary, together with the rest of their associates--the judges and officials over the men from Tripolis, Persia, Erech and Babylon, the Elamites of Susa,
- 10 and all the others whom the great and honorable Ashurbanipal deported and settled in the city of Samaria and other places in the land across the Euphrates.
- 10 and the other people whom the great and honorable Ashurbanipal deported and settled in the city of Samaria and elsewhere in Trans-Euphrates.
- 11 (This is the copy of the letter they sent to him.) To: King Artaxerxes from your servants from the land across the Euphrates.
- 11 (This is a copy of the letter they sent him.) To King Artaxerxes, From your servants, the men of Trans-Euphrates:
- 12 We are here to inform the king that the Jews who came from you to us have arrived in Jerusalem and have set about rebuilding that rebellious and evil city. They are busy at work finishing the walls and rebuilding the foundations.
- 12 The king should know that the Jews who came up to us from you have gone to Jerusalem and are rebuilding that rebellious and wicked city. They are restoring the walls and repairing the foundations.
- 13 The king needs to know that once that city is rebuilt and the wall completed they will no longer pay a penny of tribute, tax, or duty. The royal treasury will feel the loss.
- 13 Furthermore, the king should know that if this city is built and its walls are restored, no more taxes, tribute or duty will be paid, and the royal revenues will suffer.
- 14 We're loyal to the king and cannot sit idly by while our king is being insulted--that's why we are passing this information on.
- 14 Now since we are under obligation to the palace and it is not proper for us to see the king dishonored, we are sending this message to inform the king,

- 15 We suggest that you look into the court records of your ancestors; you'll learn from those books that that city is a rebellious city, a thorn in the side to kings and provinces, an historic center of unrest and revolt. That's why the city was wiped out.
- 15 so that a search may be made in the archives of your predecessors. In these records you will find that this city is a rebellious city, troublesome to kings and provinces, a place of rebellion from ancient times. That is why this city was destroyed.
- 16 We are letting the king know that if that city gets rebuilt and its walls restored, you'll end up with nothing in your province beyond the Euphrates.
- 16 We inform the king that if this city is built and its walls are restored, you will be left with nothing in Trans-Euphrates.
- 17 The king sent his reply to Rehum the commanding officer, Shimshai the secretary, and the rest of their associates who lived in Samaria and other places beyond the Euphrates. Peace be with you.
- 17 The king sent this reply: To Rehum the commanding officer, Shimshai the secretary and the rest of their associates living in Samaria and elsewhere in Trans- Euphrates: Greetings.
- 18 The letter that you sent has been translated and read to me.
- 18 The letter you sent us has been read and translated in my presence.
- 19 I gave orders to search the records, and sure enough it turns out that this city has revolted against kings time and again--rebellion is an old story there.
- 19 I issued an order and a search was made, and it was found that this city has a long history of revolt against kings and has been a place of rebellion and sedition.
- 20 I find that they've had their share of strong kings who have taken over beyond the Euphrates and exacted taxes, tribute, and duty.
- 20 Jerusalem has had powerful kings ruling over the whole of Trans-Euphrates, and taxes, tribute and duty were paid to them.
- 21 So do this: Order these men to stop work immediately--not a lick of rebuilding in that city unless I order it.
- 21 Now issue an order to these men to stop work, so that this city will not be rebuilt until I so order.
- 22 Act quickly and firmly; they've done enough damage to kings!

- 22 Be careful not to neglect this matter. Why let this threat grow, to the detriment of the royal interests?
- 23 The letter of King Artaxerxes was read to Rehum and Shimshai the secretary and their associates. They lost no time. They went to the Jews in Jerusalem and made them quit work.
- 23 As soon as the copy of the letter of King Artaxerxes was read to Rehum and Shimshai the secretary and their associates, they went immediately to the Jews in Jerusalem and compelled them by force to stop.
- 24 That put a stop to the work on The Temple of God in Jerusalem. Nothing more was done until the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.
- 24 Thus the work on the house of God in Jerusalem came to a standstill until the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.

Ezra 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Meanwhile the prophets Haggai and Zechariah son of Iddo were preaching to the Jews in Judah and Jerusalem in the authority of the God of Israel who ruled them.
- 1 Now Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the prophet, a descendant of Iddo, prophesied to the Jews in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel, who was over them.
- 2 And so Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and Jeshua son of Jozadak started again, rebuilding The Temple of God in Jerusalem. The prophets of God were right there helping them.
- 2 Then Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and Jeshua son of Jozadak set to work to rebuild the house of God in Jerusalem. And the prophets of God were with them, helping them.
- 3 Tattenai was governor of the land beyond the Euphrates at this time. Tattenai, Shethar-Bozenai, and their associates came to the Israelites and asked, "Who issued you a permit to rebuild this Temple and restore it to use?"
- 3 At that time Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shethar-Bozenai and their associates went to them and asked, "Who authorized you to

- rebuild this temple and restore this structure?"
- 4 Then we told them the names of the men responsible for this construction work.
- 4 They also asked, "What are the names of the men constructing this building?"
- 5 But God had his eye on the leaders of the Jews, and the work wasn't stopped until a report could reach Darius and an official reply be returned.
- 5 But the eye of their God was watching over the elders of the Jews, and they were not stopped until a report could go to Darius and his written reply be received.
- 6 Tattenai, governor of the land beyond the Euphrates, and Shethar-Bozenai and his associates--the officials of that land--sent a letter to Darius the king.
- 6 This is a copy of the letter that Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shethar-Bozenai and their associates, the officials of Trans-Euphrates, sent to King Darius.
- 7 This is what they wrote to him: To Darius the king. Peace and blessing!
- 7 The report they sent him read as follows: To King Darius: Cordial greetings.
- 8 We want to report to the king that we went to the province of Judah, to The Temple of the great God that is being rebuilt with large stones. Timbers are being fitted into the walls; the work is going on with great energy and in good time.
- 8 The king should know that we went to the district of Judah, to the temple of the great God. The people are building it with large stones and placing the timbers in the walls. The work is being carried on with diligence and is making rapid progress under their direction.
- 9 We asked the leaders, "Who issued you the permit to rebuild this Temple and restore it to use?"
- 9 We questioned the elders and asked them, "Who authorized you to rebuild this temple and restore this structure?"
- 10 We also asked for their names so we could pass them on to you and have a record of the men at the head of the construction work.
- 10 We also asked them their names, so that we could write down the names of their leaders for your information.

- 11 This is what they told us: "We are servants of the God of the heavens and the earth. We are rebuilding The Temple that was built a long time ago. A great king of Israel built it, the entire structure.
- 11 This is the answer they gave us: "We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and we are rebuilding the temple that was built many years ago, one that a great king of Israel built and finished.
- 12 But our ancestors made the God of the heavens really angry and he turned them over to Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, the Chaldean, who knocked this Temple down and took the people to Babylon in exile.
- 12 But because our fathers angered the God of heaven, he handed them over to Nebuchadnezzar the Chaldean, king of Babylon, who destroyed this temple and deported the people to Babylon.
- 13 "But when Cyrus became king of Babylon, in his first year he issued a building permit to rebuild this Temple of God.
- 13 However, in the first year of Cyrus king of Babylon, King Cyrus issued a decree to rebuild this house of God.
- 14 He also gave back the gold and silver vessels of The Temple of God that Nebuchadnezzar had carted off and put in the Babylon temple. Cyrus the king removed them from the temple of Babylon and turned them over to Sheshbazzar, the man he had appointed governor.
- 14 He even removed from the temple of Babylon the gold and silver articles of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar had taken from the temple in Jerusalem and brought to the temple in Babylon. "Then King Cyrus gave them to a man named Sheshbazzar, whom he had appointed governor,
- 15 He told him, "Take these vessels and place them in The Temple of Jerusalem and rebuild The Temple of God on its original site.'
- 15 and he told him, "Take these articles and go and deposit them in the temple in Jerusalem. And rebuild the house of God on its site.'
- 16 And Sheshbazzar did it. He laid the foundation of The Temple of God in Jerusalem. It has been under construction ever since but it is not yet finished."
- 16 So this Sheshbazzar came and laid the foundations of the house of God in Jerusalem. From that day to the present it has been under construction but is not yet finished."

- 17 So now, if it please the king, look up the records in the royal archives in Babylon and see if it is indeed a fact that Cyrus the king issued an official building permit authorizing the rebuilding of The Temple of God in Jerusalem. And then send the king's ruling on this matter to us.
- 17 Now if it pleases the king, let a search be made in the royal archives of Babylon to see if King Cyrus did in fact issue a decree to rebuild this house of God in Jerusalem. Then let the king send us his decision in this matter.

Ezra 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 So King Darius ordered a search through the records in the archives in Babylon.
- 1 King Darius then issued an order, and they searched in the archives stored in the treasury at Babylon.
- 2 Eventually a scroll was turned up in the fortress of Ecbatana over in the province of Media, with this writing on it: Memorandum
- 2 A scroll was found in the citadel of Ecbatana in the province of Media, and this was written on it: Memorandum:
- 3 In his first year as king, Cyrus issued an official decree regarding The Temple of God in Jerusalem, as follows: The Temple where sacrifices are offered is to be rebuilt on new foundations. It is to be ninety feet high and ninety feet wide
- 3 In the first year of King Cyrus, the king issued a decree concerning the temple of God in Jerusalem: Let the temple be rebuilt as a place to present sacrifices, and let its foundations be laid. It is to be ninety feet high and ninety feet wide,
- 4 with three courses of large stones topped with one course of timber. The cost is to be paid from the royal bank.
- 4 with three courses of large stones and one of timbers. The costs are to be paid by the royal treasury.
- 5 The gold and silver vessels from The Temple of God that Nebuchadnezzar carried to Babylon are to be returned to The Temple at Jerusalem, each to its proper place; place them in The Temple of God.

- 5 Also, the gold and silver articles of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took from the temple in Jerusalem and brought to Babylon, are to be returned to their places in the temple in Jerusalem; they are to be deposited in the house of God.
- 6 Now listen, Tattenai governor of the land beyond the Euphrates, Shethar-Bozenai, associates, and all officials of that land: Stay out of their way.
- 6 Now then, Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shethar-Bozenai and you, their fellow officials of that province, stay away from there.
- 7 Leave the governor and leaders of the Jews alone so they can work on that Temple of God as they rebuild it.
- 7 Do not interfere with the work on this temple of God. Let the governor of the Jews and the Jewish elders rebuild this house of God on its site.
- 8 I hereby give official orders on how you are to help the leaders of the Jews in the rebuilding of that Temple of God: 1. All construction costs are to be paid to these men from the royal bank out of the taxes coming in from the land beyond the Euphrates. And pay them on time, without delays.
- 8 Moreover, I hereby decree what you are to do for these elders of the Jews in the construction of this house of God: The expenses of these men are to be fully paid out of the royal treasury, from the revenues of Trans-Euphrates, so that the work will not stop.
- 9 2. Whatever is required for their worship--young bulls, rams, and lambs for Whole-Burnt-Offerings to the God-of-Heaven; and whatever wheat, salt, wine, and anointing oil the priests of Jerusalem request--is to be given to them daily without delay
- 9 Whatever is needed--young bulls, rams, male lambs for burnt offerings to the God of heaven, and wheat, salt, wine and oil, as requested by the priests in Jerusalem--must be given them daily without fail,
- 10 so that they may make sacrifices to the God-of-Heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons.
- 10 so that they may offer sacrifices pleasing to the God of heaven and pray for the well-being of the king and his sons.
- 11 I've issued an official decree that anyone who violates this order is to be impaled on a timber torn out of his own house, and the house itself made a manure pit.

- 11 Furthermore, I decree that if anyone changes this edict, a beam is to be pulled from his house and he is to be lifted up and impaled on it. And for this crime his house is to be made a pile of rubble.
- 12 And may the God who put his Name on that place wipe out any king or people who dares to defy this decree and destroy The Temple of God at Jerusalem. I, Darius, have issued an official decree. Carry it out precisely and promptly.
- 12 May God, who has caused his Name to dwell there, overthrow any king or people who lifts a hand to change this decree or to destroy this temple in Jerusalem. I Darius have decreed it. Let it be carried out with diligence.
- 13 Tattenai governor of the land across the Euphrates, Shethar-Bozenai, and their associates did it: They carried out the decree of Darius precisely and promptly.
- 13 Then, because of the decree King Darius had sent, Tattenai, governor of Trans-Euphrates, and Shethar-Bozenai and their associates carried it out with diligence.
- 14 So the leaders of the Jews continued to build; the work went well under the preaching of the prophets Haggai and Zechariah son of Iddo. They completed the rebuilding under orders of the God of Israel and authorization by Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes, kings of Persia.
- 14 So the elders of the Jews continued to build and prosper under the preaching of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah, a descendant of Iddo. They finished building the temple according to the command of the God of Israel and the decrees of Cyrus, Darius and Artaxerxes, kings of Persia.
- 15 The Temple was completed on the third day of the month Adar in the sixth year of the reign of King Darius.
- 15 The temple was completed on the third day of the month Adar, in the sixth year of the reign of King Darius.
- 16 And then the Israelites celebrated--priests, Levites, every last exile, exuberantly celebrated the dedication of The Temple of God.
- 16 Then the people of Israel--the priests, the Levites and the rest of the exiles--celebrated the dedication of the house of God with joy.
- 17 At the dedication of this Temple of God they sacrificed a hundred bulls, two hundred rams, and four hundred lambs--and, as an Absolution-

Offering for all Israel, twelve he-goats, one for each of the twelve tribes of Israel.

17 For the dedication of this house of God they offered a hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred male lambs and, as a sin offering for all Israel, twelve male goats, one for each of the tribes of Israel.

18 They placed the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their places for the service of God at Jerusalem--all as written out in the Book of Moses.

18 And they installed the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their groups for the service of God at Jerusalem, according to what is written in the Book of Moses.

19 On the fourteenth day of the first month, the exiles celebrated the Passover.

19 On the fourteenth day of the first month, the exiles celebrated the Passover.

20 All the priests and Levites had purified themselves--all, no exceptions. They were all ritually clean. The Levites slaughtered the Passover lamb for the exiles, their brother priests, and themselves.

20 The priests and Levites had purified themselves and were all ceremonially clean. The Levites slaughtered the Passover lamb for all the exiles, for their brothers the priests and for themselves.

21 Then the Israelites who had returned from exile, along with everyone who had removed themselves from the defilements of the nations to join them and seek GOD, the God of Israel, ate the Passover.

21 So the Israelites who had returned from the exile ate it, together with all who had separated themselves from the unclean practices of their Gentile neighbors in order to seek the LORD, the God of Israel.

22 With great joy they celebrated the Feast of Unraised Bread for seven days. GOD had plunged them into a sea of joy; he had changed the mind of the king of Assyria to back them in rebuilding The Temple of God, the God of Israel.

22 For seven days they celebrated with joy the Feast of Unleavened Bread, because the LORD had filled them with joy by changing the attitude of the king of Assyria, so that he assisted them in the work on the house of God, the God of Israel.

Ezra 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 After all this, Ezra. It was during the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia. Ezra was the son of Seraiah, son of Azariah, son of Hilkiah,
- 1 After these things, during the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,
- 2 son of Shallum, son of Zadok, son of Ahitub,
- 2 the son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,
- 3 son of Amariah, son of Azariah, son of Meraioth,
- 3 the son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,
- 4 son of Zerahiah, son of Uzzi, son of Bukki,
- 4 the son of Zerahiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,
- 5 son of Abishua, son of Phinehas, son of Eleazar, son of Aaron the high priest.
- 5 the son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest--
- 6 That's Ezra. He arrived from Babylon, a scholar well-practiced in the Revelation of Moses that the GOD of Israel had given. Because GOD's hand was on Ezra, the king gave him everything he asked for.
- 6 this Ezra came up from Babylon. He was a teacher well versed in the Law of Moses, which the LORD, the God of Israel, had given. The king had granted him everything he asked, for the hand of the LORD his God was on him.
- 7 Some of the Israelites--priests, Levites, singers, temple security guards, and temple slaves--went with him to Jerusalem. It was in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.
- 7 Some of the Israelites, including priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers and temple servants, also came up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of King Artaxerxes.
- 8 They arrived at Jerusalem in the fifth month of the seventh year of the king's reign.
- 8 Ezra arrived in Jerusalem in the fifth month of the seventh year of the king.

- 9 Ezra had scheduled their departure from Babylon on the first day of the first month; they arrived in Jerusalem on the first day of the fifth month under the generous guidance of his God.
- 9 He had begun his journey from Babylon on the first day of the first month, and he arrived in Jerusalem on the first day of the fifth month, for the gracious hand of his God was on him.
- 10 Ezra had committed himself to studying the Revelation of GOD, to living it, and to teaching Israel to live its truths and ways.
- 10 For Ezra had devoted himself to the study and observance of the Law of the LORD, and to teaching its decrees and laws in Israel.
- 11 What follows is the letter that King Artaxerxes gave Ezra, priest and scholar, expert in matters involving the truths and ways of GOD concerning Israel:
- 11 This is a copy of the letter King Artaxerxes had given to Ezra the priest and teacher, a man learned in matters concerning the commands and decrees of the LORD for Israel:
- 12 Artaxerxes, King of Kings, to Ezra the priest, a scholar of the Teaching of the God-of-Heaven. Peace.
- 12 Artaxerxes, king of kings, To Ezra the priest, a teacher of the Law of the God of heaven: Greetings.
- 13 I hereby decree that any of the people of Israel living in my kingdom who want to go to Jerusalem, including their priests and Levites, may go with you.
- 13 Now I decree that any of the Israelites in my kingdom, including priests and Levites, who wish to go to Jerusalem with you, may go.
- 14 You are being sent by the king and his seven advisors to carry out an investigation of Judah and Jerusalem in relation to the Teaching of your God that you are carrying with you.
- 14 You are sent by the king and his seven advisers to inquire about Judah and Jerusalem with regard to the Law of your God, which is in your hand.
- 15 You are also authorized to take the silver and gold that the king and his advisors are giving for the God of Israel, whose residence is in Jerusalem,
- 15 Moreover, you are to take with you the silver and gold that the king and his advisers have freely given to the God of Israel, whose dwelling is in

Jerusalem,

- 16 along with all the silver and gold that has been collected from the generously donated offerings all over Babylon, including that from the people and the priests, for The Temple of their God in Jerusalem.
- 16 together with all the silver and gold you may obtain from the province of Babylon, as well as the freewill offerings of the people and priests for the temple of their God in Jerusalem.
- 17 Use this money carefully to buy bulls, rams, lambs, and the ingredients for Grain-Offerings and Drink-Offerings and then offer them on the Altar of The Temple of your God in Jerusalem.
- 17 With this money be sure to buy bulls, rams and male lambs, together with their grain offerings and drink offerings, and sacrifice them on the altar of the temple of your God in Jerusalem.
- 18 You are free to use whatever is left over from the silver and gold for what you and your brothers decide is in keeping with the will of your God.
- 18 You and your brother Jews may then do whatever seems best with the rest of the silver and gold, in accordance with the will of your God.
- 19 Deliver to the God of Jerusalem the vessels given to you for the services of worship in The Temple of your God.
- 19 Deliver to the God of Jerusalem all the articles entrusted to you for worship in the temple of your God.
- 20 Whatever else you need for The Temple of your God you may pay for out of the royal bank.
- 20 And anything else needed for the temple of your God that you may have occasion to supply, you may provide from the royal treasury.
- 21 I, Artaxerxes the king, have formally authorized and ordered all the treasurers of the land across the Euphrates to give Ezra the priest, scholar of the Teaching of the God-of-Heaven, the full amount of whatever he asks for
- 21 Now I, King Artaxerxes, order all the treasurers of Trans-Euphrates to provide with diligence whatever Ezra the priest, a teacher of the Law of the God of heaven, may ask of you--
- 22 up to a hundred talents of silver, six hundred and fifty bushels of wheat, and six hundred and seven gallons each of wine and olive oil. There is no limit on the salt.

- 22 up to a hundred talents of silver, a hundred cors of wheat, a hundred baths of wine, a hundred baths of olive oil, and salt without limit.
- 23 Everything the God-of-Heaven requires for The Temple of God must be given without hesitation. Why would the king and his sons risk stirring up his wrath?
- 23 Whatever the God of heaven has prescribed, let it be done with diligence for the temple of the God of heaven. Why should there be wrath against the realm of the king and of his sons?
- 24 Also, let it be clear that no one is permitted to impose tribute, tax, or duty on any priest, Levite, singer, temple security guard, temple servant, or any other worker connected with The Temple of God.
- 24 You are also to know that you have no authority to impose taxes, tribute or duty on any of the priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, temple servants or other workers at this house of God.
- 25 I authorize you, Ezra, exercising the wisdom of God that you have in your hands, to appoint magistrates and judges so they can administer justice among all the people of the land across the Euphrates who live by the Teaching of your God. Anyone who does not know the Teaching, you teach them.
- 25 And you, Ezra, in accordance with the wisdom of your God, which you possess, appoint magistrates and judges to administer justice to all the people of Trans-Euphrates--all who know the laws of your God. And you are to teach any who do not know them.
- 26 Anyone who does not obey the Teaching of your God and the king must be tried and sentenced at once--death, banishment, a fine, prison, whatever.
- 26 Whoever does not obey the law of your God and the law of the king must surely be punished by death, banishment, confiscation of property, or imprisonment.
- 27 Blessed be GOD, the God-of-Our-Fathers, who put it in the mind of the king to beautify The Temple of GOD in Jerusalem!
- 27 Praise be to the LORD, the God of our fathers, who has put it into the king's heart to bring honor to the house of the LORD in Jerusalem in this way
- 28 Not only that, he caused the king and all his advisors and influential officials actually to like me and back me. My God was on my side and I

was ready to go. And I organized all the leaders of Israel to go with me.
28 and who has extended his good favor to me before the king and his advisers and all the king's powerful officials. Because the hand of the LORD my God was on me, I took courage and gathered leading men from Israel to go up with me.

Ezra 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the family heads and those who signed up to go up with me from Babylon in the reign of Artaxerxes the king:
- 1 These are the family heads and those registered with them who came up with me from Babylon during the reign of King Artaxerxes:
- 2 From the family of Phinehas: Gershom; Family of Ithamar: Daniel; Family of David: Hattush;
- 2 of the descendants of Phinehas, Gershom; of the descendants of Ithamar, Daniel; of the descendants of David, Hattush
- 3 Family of Shecaniah; Family of Parosh: Zechariah, and with him 150 men signed up
- 3 of the descendants of Shecaniah; of the descendants of Parosh, Zechariah, and with him were registered 150 men;
- 4 Family of Pahath-Moab: Eliehoenai son of Zerahiah, and 200 men
- 4 of the descendants of Pahath-Moab, Eliehoenai son of Zerahiah, and with him 200 men;
- 5 Family of Zattu: Shecaniah son of Jahaziel, and 300 men
- 5 of the descendants of Zattu, Shecaniah son of Jahaziel, and with him 300 men;
- 6 Family of Adin: Ebed son of Jonathan, and 50 men
- 6 of the descendants of Adin, Ebed son of Jonathan, and with him 50 men;
- 7 Family of Elam: Jeshaiah son of Athaliah, and 70 men
- 7 of the descendants of Elam, Jeshaiah son of Athaliah, and with him 70 men;
- 8 Family of Shephatiah: Zebadiah son of Michael, and 80 men
- 8 of the descendants of Shephatiah, Zebadiah son of Michael, and with him 80 men;

- 9 Family of Joab: Obadiah son of Jehiel, and 218 men
9 of the descendants of Joab, Obadiah son of Jehiel, and with him 218 men;
10 Family of Bani: Shelomith son of Josiphiah, and 160 men
10 of the descendants of Bani, Shelomith son of Josiphiah, and with him 160 men;
11 Family of Bebai: Zechariah son of Bebai, and 28 men
11 of the descendants of Bebai, Zechariah son of Bebai, and with him 28 men;
12 Family of Azgad: Johanan son of Hakkatan, and 110 men
12 of the descendants of Azgad, Johanan son of Hakkatan, and with him 110 men;
13 Family of Adonikam (bringing up the rear): their names were Eliphelet, Jeuel, Shemaiah, and 60 men
13 of the descendants of Adonikam, the last ones, whose names were Eliphelet, Jeuel and Shemaiah, and with them 60 men;
14 Family of Bigvai: Uthai and Zaccur, and 70 men.
14 of the descendants of Bigvai, Uthai and Zaccur, and with them 70 men.
15 I gathered them together at the canal that runs to Ahava. We camped there three days. I looked them over and found that they were all laymen and priests but no Levites.
15 I assembled them at the canal that flows toward Ahava, and we camped there three days. When I checked among the people and the priests, I found no Levites there.
16 So I sent for the leaders Eliezer, Ariel, Shemaiah, Elnathan, Jarib, Elnathan, Nathan, Zechariah, and Meshullam, and for the teachers Joiarib and Elnathan.
16 So I summoned Eliezer, Ariel, Shemaiah, Elnathan, Jarib, Elnathan, Nathan, Zechariah and Meshullam, who were leaders, and Joiarib and Elnathan, who were men of learning,
17 I then sent them to Iddo, who is head of the town of Casiphia, and told them what to say to Iddo and his relatives who lived there in Casiphia: "Send us ministers for The Temple of God."
17 and I sent them to Iddo, the leader in Casiphia. I told them what to say to Iddo and his kinsmen, the temple servants in Casiphia, so that they might bring attendants to us for the house of our God.

- 18 Well, the generous hand of our God was on us, and they brought back to us a wise man from the family of Mahli son of Levi, the son of Israel. His name was Sherebiah. With sons and brothers they numbered eighteen.
- 18 Because the gracious hand of our God was on us, they brought us Sherebiah, a capable man, from the descendants of Mahli son of Levi, the son of Israel, and Sherebiah's sons and brothers, 18 men;
- 19 They also brought Hashabiah and Jeshaiah of the family of Merari, with brothers and their sons, another twenty.
- 19 and Hashabiah, together with Jeshaiah from the descendants of Merari, and his brothers and nephews, 20 men.
- 20 And then there were 220 temple servants, descendants of the temple servants that David and the princes had assigned to help the Levites in their work. They were all signed up by name.
- 20 They also brought 220 of the temple servants--a body that David and the officials had established to assist the Levites. All were registered by name.
- 21 I proclaimed a fast there beside the Ahava Canal, a fast to humble ourselves before our God and pray for wise guidance for our journey--all our people and possessions.
- 21 There, by the Ahava Canal, I proclaimed a fast, so that we might humble ourselves before our God and ask him for a safe journey for us and our children, with all our possessions.
- 22 I was embarrassed to ask the king for a cavalry bodyguard to protect us from bandits on the road. We had just told the king, "Our God lovingly looks after all those who seek him, but turns away in disgust from those who leave him."
- 22 I was ashamed to ask the king for soldiers and horsemen to protect us from enemies on the road, because we had told the king, "The gracious hand of our God is on everyone who looks to him, but his great anger is against all who forsake him."
- 23 So we fasted and prayed about these concerns. And he listened.
- 23 So we fasted and petitioned our God about this, and he answered our prayer.
- 24 Then I picked twelve of the leading priests--Sherebiah and Hashabiah with ten of their brothers.

24 Then I set apart twelve of the leading priests, together with Sherebiah, Hashabiah and ten of their brothers,

25 I weighed out for them the silver, the gold, the vessels, and the offerings for The Temple of our God that the king, his advisors, and all the Israelites had given:

25 and I weighed out to them the offering of silver and gold and the articles that the king, his advisers, his officials and all Israel present there had donated for the house of our God.

26 25 tons of silver, 100 vessels of silver valued at three and three-quarter tons, three and three-quarter tons of gold

26 I weighed out to them 650 talents of silver, silver articles weighing 100 talents, 100 talents of gold,

27 20 gold bowls weighing eighteen and a half pounds, 2 vessels of bright red copper, as valuable as gold.

27 20 bowls of gold valued at 1,000 darics, and two fine articles of polished bronze, as precious as gold.

28 I said to them, "You are holy to GOD and these vessels are holy. The silver and gold are Freewill-Offerings to the GOD of your ancestors.

28 I said to them, "You as well as these articles are consecrated to the LORD. The silver and gold are a freewill offering to the LORD, the God of your fathers.

29 Guard them with your lives until you're able to weigh them out in a secure place in The Temple of our God for the priests and Levites and family heads who are in charge in Jerusalem."

29 Guard them carefully until you weigh them out in the chambers of the house of the LORD in Jerusalem before the leading priests and the Levites and the family heads of Israel."

30 The priests and Levites took charge of all that had been weighed out to them, and prepared to deliver it to Jerusalem to The Temple of our God.

30 Then the priests and Levites received the silver and gold and sacred articles that had been weighed out to be taken to the house of our God in Jerusalem.

31 We left the Ahava Canal on the twelfth day of the first month to travel to Jerusalem. God was with us all the way and kept us safe from bandits and highwaymen.

- 31 On the twelfth day of the first month we set out from the Ahava Canal to go to Jerusalem. The hand of our God was on us, and he protected us from enemies and bandits along the way.
- 32 We arrived in Jerusalem and waited there three days.
- 32 So we arrived in Jerusalem, where we rested three days.
- 33 On the fourth day the silver and gold and vessels were weighed out in The Temple of our God into the hands of Meremoth son of Uriah, the priest. Eleazar son of Phinehas was there with him, also the Levites Jozabad son of Jeshua and Noadiah son of Binnui.
- 33 On the fourth day, in the house of our God, we weighed out the silver and gold and the sacred articles into the hands of Meremoth son of Uriah, the priest. Eleazar son of Phinehas was with him, and so were the Levites Jozabad son of Jeshua and Noadiah son of Binnui.
- 34 Everything was counted and weighed and the totals recorded.
- 34 Everything was accounted for by number and weight, and the entire weight was recorded at that time.
- 35 When they arrived, the exiles, now returned from captivity, offered Whole-Burnt-Offerings to the God of Israel: 12 bulls, representing all Israel, 96 rams, 77 lambs, 12 he-goats as an Absolution-Offering. All of this was sacrificed as a Whole-Burnt-Offering to GOD.
- 35 Then the exiles who had returned from captivity sacrificed burnt offerings to the God of Israel: twelve bulls for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven male lambs and, as a sin offering, twelve male goats. All this was a burnt offering to the LORD.
- 36 They also delivered the king's orders to the king's provincial administration assigned to the land beyond the Euphrates. They, in turn, gave their support to the people and The Temple of God.
- 36 They also delivered the king's orders to the royal satraps and to the governors of Trans-Euphrates, who then gave assistance to the people and to the house of God.

Ezra 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 After all this was done, the leaders came to me and said, "The People of Israel, priests and Levites included, have not kept themselves separate from the neighboring people around here with all their vulgar obscenities--Canaanites, Hittites, Perizzites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egyptians, Amorites.
- 1 After these things had been done, the leaders came to me and said, "The people of Israel, including the priests and the Levites, have not kept themselves separate from the neighboring peoples with their detestable practices, like those of the Canaanites, Hittites, Perizzites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egyptians and Amorites.
- 2 They have given some of their daughters in marriage to them and have taken some of their daughters for marriage to their sons. The holy seed is now all mixed in with these other peoples. And our leaders have led the way in this betrayal."
- 2 They have taken some of their daughters as wives for themselves and their sons, and have mingled the holy race with the peoples around them. And the leaders and officials have led the way in this unfaithfulness."
- 3 When I heard all this, I ripped my clothes and my cape; I pulled hair from my head and out of my beard; I slumped to the ground, appalled.
- 3 When I heard this, I tore my tunic and cloak, pulled hair from my head and beard and sat down appalled.
- 4 Many were in fear and trembling because of what God was saying about the betrayal by the exiles. They gathered around me as I sat there in despair, waiting for the evening sacrifice.
- 4 Then everyone who trembled at the words of the God of Israel gathered around me because of this unfaithfulness of the exiles. And I sat there appalled until the evening sacrifice.
- 5 At the evening sacrifice I picked myself up from my utter devastation, and in my ripped clothes and cape fell to my knees and stretched out my hands to GOD, my God.
- 5 Then, at the evening sacrifice, I rose from my self- abasement, with my tunic and cloak torn, and fell on my knees with my hands spread out to the LORD my God
- 6 And I prayed: "My dear God, I'm so totally ashamed, I can't bear to face you. O my God--our iniquities are piled up so high that we can't see out; our guilt touches the skies.

- 6 and prayed: "O my God, I am too ashamed and disgraced to lift up my face to you, my God, because our sins are higher than our heads and our guilt has reached to the heavens.
- 7 We've been stuck in a muck of guilt since the time of our ancestors until right now; we and our kings and priests, because of our sins, have been turned over to foreign kings, to killing, to captivity, to looting, and to public shame--just as you see us now.
- 7 From the days of our forefathers until now, our guilt has been great. Because of our sins, we and our kings and our priests have been subjected to the sword and captivity, to pillage and humiliation at the hand of foreign kings, as it is today.
- 8 "Now for a brief time GOD, our God, has allowed us, this battered band, to get a firm foothold in his holy place so that our God may brighten our eyes and lighten our burdens as we serve out this hard sentence.
- 8 But now, for a brief moment, the LORD our God has been gracious in leaving us a remnant and giving us a firm place in his sanctuary, and so our God gives light to our eyes and a little relief in our bondage.
- 9 We were slaves; yet even as slaves, our God didn't abandon us. He has put us in the good graces of the kings of Persia and given us the heart to build The Temple of our God, restore its ruins, and construct a defensive wall in Judah and Jerusalem.
- 9 Though we are slaves, our God has not deserted us in our bondage. He has shown us kindness in the sight of the kings of Persia: He has granted us new life to rebuild the house of our God and repair its ruins, and he has given us a wall of protection in Judah and Jerusalem.
- 10 "And now, our God, after all this what can we say for ourselves? For we have thrown your commands to the wind,
- 10 But now, O our God, what can we say after this? For we have disregarded the commands
- 11 the commands you gave us through your servants the prophets. They told us, 'The land you're taking over is a polluted land, polluted with the obscene vulgarities of the people who live there; they've filled it with their moral rot from one end to the other.
- 11 you gave through your servants the prophets when you said: 'The land you are entering to possess is a land polluted by the corruption of its

- peoples. By their detestable practices they have filled it with their impurity from one end to the other.
- 12 Whatever you do, don't give your daughters in marriage to their sons nor marry your sons to their daughters. Don't cultivate their good opinion; don't make over them and get them to like you so you can make a lot of money and build up a tidy estate to hand down to your children.'
- 12 Therefore, do not give your daughters in marriage to their sons or take their daughters for your sons. Do not seek a treaty of friendship with them at any time, that you may be strong and eat the good things of the land and leave it to your children as an everlasting inheritance.'
- 13 "And now this, on top of all we've already suffered because of our evil ways and accumulated guilt, even though you, dear God, punished us far less than we deserved and even went ahead and gave us this present escape.
- 13 What has happened to us is a result of our evil deeds and our great guilt, and yet, our God, you have punished us less than our sins have deserved and have given us a remnant like this.
- 14 Yet here we are, at it again, breaking your commandments by intermarrying with the people who practice all these obscenities! Are you angry to the point of wiping us out completely, without even a few stragglers, with no way out at all?
- 14 Shall we again break your commands and intermarry with the peoples who commit such detestable practices? Would you not be angry enough with us to destroy us, leaving us no remnant or survivor?
- 15 You are the righteous GOD of Israel. We are, right now, a small band of escapees. Look at us, openly standing here, guilty before you. No one can last long like this."
- 15 O LORD, God of Israel, you are righteous! We are left this day as a remnant. Here we are before you in our guilt, though because of it not one of us can stand in your presence."

Ezra 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Ezra wept, prostrate in front of The Temple of God. As he prayed and confessed, a huge number of the men, women, and children of Israel gathered around him. All the people were now weeping as if their hearts would break.
- 1 While Ezra was praying and confessing, weeping and throwing himself down before the house of God, a large crowd of Israelites-- men, women and children--gathered around him. They too wept bitterly.
- 2 Shecaniah son of Jehiel of the family of Elam, acting as spokesman, said to Ezra: "We betrayed our God by marrying foreign wives from the people around here. But all is not lost; there is still hope for Israel.
- 2 Then Shecaniah son of Jehiel, one of the descendants of Elam, said to Ezra, "We have been unfaithful to our God by marrying foreign women from the peoples around us. But in spite of this, there is still hope for Israel.
- 3 Let's make a covenant right now with our God, agreeing to get rid of all these wives and their children, just as my master and those who honor God's commandment are saying. It's what The Revelation says, so let's do it.
- 3 Now let us make a covenant before our God to send away all these women and their children, in accordance with the counsel of my lord and of those who fear the commands of our God. Let it be done according to the Law.
- 4 "Now get up, Ezra. Take charge--we're behind you. Don't back down."
- 4 Rise up; this matter is in your hands. We will support you, so take courage and do it."
- 5 So Ezra stood up and had the leaders of the priests, the Levites, and all Israel solemnly swear to do what Shecaniah proposed. And they did it.
- 5 So Ezra rose up and put the leading priests and Levites and all Israel under oath to do what had been suggested. And they took the oath.
- 6 Then Ezra left the plaza in front of The Temple of God and went to the home of Jehohanan son of Eliashib where he stayed, still fasting from food and drink, continuing his mourning over the betrayal by the exiles.
- 6 Then Ezra withdrew from before the house of God and went to the room of Jehohanan son of Eliashib. While he was there, he ate no food and drank no water, because he continued to mourn over the unfaithfulness of the exiles.

- 7 A notice was then sent throughout Judah and Jerusalem ordering all the exiles to meet in Jerusalem.
- 7 A proclamation was then issued throughout Judah and Jerusalem for all the exiles to assemble in Jerusalem.
- 8 Anyone who failed to show up in three days, in compliance with the ruling of the leaders and elders, would have all his possessions confiscated and be thrown out of the congregation of the returned exiles.
- 8 Anyone who failed to appear within three days would forfeit all his property, in accordance with the decision of the officials and elders, and would himself be expelled from the assembly of the exiles.
- 9 All the men of Judah and Benjamin met in Jerusalem within the three days. It was the twentieth day of the ninth month. They all sat down in the plaza in front of The Temple of God. Because of the business before them, and aggravated by the buckets of rain coming down on them, they were restless, uneasy, and anxious.
- 9 Within the three days, all the men of Judah and Benjamin had gathered in Jerusalem. And on the twentieth day of the ninth month, all the people were sitting in the square before the house of God, greatly distressed by the occasion and because of the rain.
- 10 Ezra the priest stood up and spoke: "You've broken trust. You've married foreign wives. You've piled guilt on Israel.
- 10 Then Ezra the priest stood up and said to them, "You have been unfaithful; you have married foreign women, adding to Israel's guilt.
- 11 Now make your confession to GOD, the God of your ancestors, and do what he wants you to do: Separate yourselves from the people of the land and from your foreign wives."
- 11 Now make confession to the LORD, the God of your fathers, and do his will. Separate yourselves from the peoples around you and from your foreign wives."
- 12 The whole congregation responded with a shout, "Yes, we'll do it--just the way you said it!"
- 12 The whole assembly responded with a loud voice: "You are right! We must do as you say.
- 13 They also said, "But look, do you see how many people there are out here? And it's the rainy season; you can't expect us to stand out here

soaking wet until this is done--why, it will take days! A lot of us are deeply involved in this transgression.

13 But there are many people here and it is the rainy season; so we cannot stand outside. Besides, this matter cannot be taken care of in a day or two, because we have sinned greatly in this thing.

14 Let our leaders act on behalf of the whole congregation. Have everybody who lives in cities and who has married a foreign wife come at an appointed time, accompanied by the elders and judges of each city. We'll keep at this until the hot anger of our God over this thing is turned away."

14 Let our officials act for the whole assembly. Then let everyone in our towns who has married a foreign woman come at a set time, along with the elders and judges of each town, until the fierce anger of our God in this matter is turned away from us."

15 Only Jonathan son of Asahel and Jahzeiah son of Tikvah, supported by Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite, opposed this.

15 Only Jonathan son of Asahel and Jahzeiah son of Tikvah, supported by Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite, opposed this.

16 So the exiles went ahead with the plan. Ezra the priest picked men who were family heads, each one by name. They sat down together on the first day of the tenth month to pursue the matter.

16 So the exiles did as was proposed. Ezra the priest selected men who were family heads, one from each family division, and all of them designated by name. On the first day of the tenth month they sat down to investigate the cases,

17 By the first day of the first month they had finished dealing with every man who had married a foreign wife.

17 and by the first day of the first month they finished dealing with all the men who had married foreign women.

18 Among the families of priests, the following were found to have married foreign wives: The family of Jeshua son of Jozadak and his brothers: Maaseiah, Eliezer, Jarib, and Gedaliah.

18 Among the descendants of the priests, the following had married foreign women: From the descendants of Jeshua son of Jozadak, and his brothers: Maaseiah, Eliezer, Jarib and Gedaliah.

- 19 They all promised to divorce their wives and sealed it with a handshake. For their guilt they brought a ram from the flock as a Compensation-Offering.
- 19 (They all gave their hands in pledge to put away their wives, and for their guilt they each presented a ram from the flock as a guilt offering.)
- 20 The family of Immer: Hanani and Zebadiah.
- 20 From the descendants of Immer: Hanani and Zebadiah.
- 21 The family of Harim: Maaseiah, Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel, and Uziah.
- 21 From the descendants of Harim: Maaseiah, Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel and Uziah.
- 22 The family of Pashhur: Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel, Jozabad, and Elasah.
- 22 From the descendants of Pashhur: Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel, Jozabad and Elasah.
- 23 From the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei, Kelaiah--that is, Kelita--Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.
- 23 Among the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei, Kelaiah (that is, Kelita), Pethahiah, Judah and Eliezer.
- 24 From the singers: Eliashib. From the temple security guards: Shallum, Telem, and Uri.
- 24 From the singers: Eliashib. From the gatekeepers: Shallum, Telem and Uri.
- 25 And from the other Israelites: The family of Parosh: Ramiah, Izziah, Malkijah, Mijamin, Eleazar, Malkijah, and Benaiah.
- 25 And among the other Israelites: From the descendants of Parosh: Ramiah, Izziah, Malkijah, Mijamin, Eleazar, Malkijah and Benaiah.
- 26 The family of Elam: Mattaniah, Zechariah, Jehiel, Abdi, Jeremoth, and Elijah.
- 26 From the descendants of Elam: Mattaniah, Zechariah, Jehiel, Abdi, Jeremoth and Elijah.
- 27 The family of Zattu: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad, and Aziza.
- 27 From the descendants of Zattu: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad and Aziza.
- 28 The family of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.

- 28 From the descendants of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai and Athlai.
- 29 The family of Bani: Meshullam, Malluch, Adaiah, Jashub, Sheal, and Jeremoth.
- 29 From the descendants of Bani: Meshullam, Malluch, Adaiah, Jashub, Sheal and Jeremoth.
- 30 The family of Pahath-Moab: Adna, Kelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezalel, Binnui, and Manasseh.
- 30 From the descendants of Pahath-Moab: Adna, Kelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezalel, Binnui and Manasseh.
- 31 The family of Harim: Eliezer, Ishijah, Malkijah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,
- 31 From the descendants of Harim: Eliezer, Ishijah, Malkijah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,
- 32 Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.
- 32 Benjamin, Malluch and Shemariah.
- 33 The family of Hashum: Mattenai, Mattattah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei.
- 33 From the descendants of Hashum: Mattenai, Mattattah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh and Shimei.
- 34 The family of Bani: Maadai, Amram, Uel,
- 34 From the descendants of Bani: Maadai, Amram, Uel,
- 35 Benaiah, Bedeiah, Keluhi,
- 35 Benaiah, Bedeiah, Keluhi,
- 36 Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,
- 36 Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,
- 37 Mattaniah, Mattenai, and Jaasu.
- 37 Mattaniah, Mattenai and Jaasu.
- 38 The family of Binnui: Shimei,
- 38 From the descendants of Binnui: Shimei,
- 39 Shelemiah, Nathan, Adaiah,
- 39 Shelemiah, Nathan, Adaiah,
- 40 Macnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,
- 40 Macnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,
- 41 Azarel, Shelemiah, Shemariah,
- 41 Azarel, Shelemiah, Shemariah,
- 42 Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.

42 Shallum, Amariah and Joseph.

43 The family of Nebo: Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jaddai, Joel, and Benaiah.

43 From the descendants of Nebo: Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jaddai, Joel and Benaiah.

44 All these had married foreign wives and some had also had children by them.

44 All these had married foreign women, and some of them had children by these wives.